

HOW TO MAKE ICY ORBS

This simple but effective experiment creates spectacular results: simply make a ball of ice, add salt and food coloring, and watch fabulous patterns paint the ice. You will need to be careful, though; adding salt to ice makes the ice even colder—a mixture of salt and ice can get as cold as -6°F (-21°C), so make sure you don't touch the ice when it is mixed with the salt.

WHAT YOU NEED



Food coloring (the more colors, the better)



Balloon



Large bowl



Salt



Scissors

You will also need a freezer and a water faucet



Time

10 minutes plus
freezing time



Difficulty

Easy



If there is space in your freezer, put the water-filled balloon in a bowl, so it keeps its round shape.

1 Place your balloon's opening over the end of a cold-water faucet. Turn it on to a trickle and half-fill the balloon with water. Remove and tie off the balloon—ask an adult for help if you need it. Put the balloon in the freezer and leave it overnight.

If the ice feels too cold for your hands, wear some gloves.



2 The next day, remove the balloon from the freezer. It should feel hard because the liquid water has turned into solid ice. Cut the tied end off the balloon, and peel off the rubber.